
LECTURE 11: PERSONALITY

1. Individuality

Slide Idea (Restated Clearly)

Every person can be understood in **three ways** (Kluckhohn & Murray, 1948):

1. **Like all other persons**
 - We share basic human characteristics
 - Example: all humans feel emotions
 2. **Like some other persons**
 - We belong to groups (culture, gender, personality type)
 - Example: some people are introverts, some are extroverts
 3. **Like no other person**
 - Unique traits and personal experiences
 - Example: your exact combination of habits, memories, and preferences
-

2. What Is Personality?

Clear Definition (From Slide)

Personality is a **set of behavioral, emotional, and cognitive tendencies** that:

- appear **consistently over time**,
- appear **across situations**, and
- **distinguish individuals** from one another.

Explanation

It means personality is **stable** (doesn't change every day) and **consistent** (appears in different settings).

Example

A responsible person tends to be responsible at home, school, and work.

3. Measuring Personality

Slides list the following methods:

3.1 Interview

- Asking questions to understand traits
- Example: a job interview assessing confidence

3.2 Observation

- Watching behavior in natural settings
- Example: observing children in a classroom

3.3 Inventory / Questionnaire

- Self-report tests
- Example: Big Five personality test

3.4 Factor Analysis

- A statistical technique
 - Groups related traits together
 - Used to identify major personality dimensions
-

4. Introduction to Personality Theories

Slides list **four major perspectives**:

1. **Psychodynamic**
 - Focus on unconscious processes and early childhood
2. **Humanistic**
 - Focus on growth, free will, self-actualization
3. **Trait**
 - Focus on describing personality through traits
4. **Social-Cognitive**
 - Focus on learning, thinking, environment

(Slides don't explain these in detail, so short definitions only.)

5. Psychodynamic Theory

Slide Definition

Psychodynamic theory emphasizes:

- the **unconscious mind**
- **early childhood experiences**
- **inner psychological conflicts**

Origin:

Developed by **Sigmund Freud** in late 19th century.

Example

A person afraid of dogs without remembering why → could be due to unconscious childhood memory.

6. Freud's Structure of the Mind

Three Components

6.1 Id

- Primitive part
- Seeks pleasure
- Immediate gratification
- Example: wanting to eat cake RIGHT NOW

6.2 Ego

- Rational, realistic
- Follows the **reality principle**
- Balances id and superego
- Example: "I'll eat cake after dinner."

6.3 Superego

- Moral standards, conscience
- Judges actions as right/wrong
- Example: "You shouldn't eat cake; it's unhealthy."

Explanation

Behavior comes from **conflict** between id, ego, and superego.

7. Ego Defense Mechanisms

Definition (Slide)

Defense mechanisms are **unconscious strategies** used by the ego to protect itself from anxiety caused by id–superego conflict.

Defense Mechanisms (from slides):

7.1 Denial

Refusing to accept reality.

Example: A smoker refusing to believe smoking is harmful.

7.2 Repression

Unconsciously pushing unwanted thoughts away.

Example: Forgetting a traumatic event.

7.3 Projection

Attributing your feelings to someone else.

Example: A rude person calling others “rude.”

7.4 Displacement

Redirecting impulses to a safer target.

Example: Angry at boss → yelling at family.

More Defense Mechanisms (next slide)

7.5 Regression

Going back to childish behavior during stress.

Example: An adult throwing a tantrum.

7.6 Sublimation

Turning unacceptable impulses into acceptable actions.

Example: Aggressive person becoming a boxer.

7.7 Rationalization

Creating excuses to justify behavior.

Example: “I failed because the test was unfair.”

7.8 Reaction Formation

Showing the opposite of true feelings.

Example: Acting overly friendly toward someone you dislike.

8. Trait Theory: The Big Five

Slide Introduction

- Personality psychology studies differences in behavior, emotion, and thoughts.
- The **Big Five Theory** is the most widely accepted trait model.
- Also called **Five-Factor Model (FFM)**.

Origin

Developed through **factor analysis**

Pioneers:

- Lewis Goldberg
- Costa & McCrae

9. The Big Five Personality Traits

9.1 Openness to Experience

- Imaginative, curious, artistic
- **High:** creative, open-minded
- **Low:** practical, prefers routine

Example:

High openness → enjoys exploring new cultures.

9.2 Conscientiousness

- Organized, dependable, goal-oriented
- **High:** disciplined, reliable
- **Low:** impulsive, careless

Example:

High conscientiousness → submits assignments early.

9.3 Extraversion

- Sociable, energetic, talkative
- **High:** outgoing, assertive
- **Low:** quiet, introverted

Example:

High extraversion → enjoys parties.

9.4 Agreeableness

- Kind, empathetic, cooperative
- **High:** warm, helpful
- **Low:** competitive, critical

Example:

High agreeableness → helps classmates often.

9.5 Neuroticism

- Emotional instability, anxiety
- **High:** easily stressed, sensitive
- **Low:** calm, stable

Example:

High neuroticism → worries before exams.

10. Applications of the Big Five (Slide List)

Used in:

- Psychological research
- Employee selection
- Mental health assessment
- Career counseling

Helps predict behaviors such as:

- Job performance
- Relationship patterns
- Overall well-being

FINAL SUMMARY TABLE (Slide-Accurate)

Topic	Key Idea
Personality	Consistent behavioral/emotional/cognitive tendencies
Measuring	Interview, observation, inventory, factor analysis
Major Theories	Psychodynamic, humanistic, trait, social-cognitive
Freud	Id, ego, superego + defense mechanisms
Big Five	O, C, E, A, N
Applications	Jobs, research, mental health, counseling
